

ROUND SUMMARY -- ALL TIPS AT A GLANCE

MATCH	VENUE	DATE	TIP	PROB	MARGIN	
Collingwood vs Hawthorn	MCG	2026-04-30	Hawthorn	68%	~20pts	M
Western Bulldogs vs Freman	Docklands	2026-05-01	Fremantle	58%	~15pts	M
Adelaide vs Port Adelaide	Adelaide Oval	2026-05-01	Adelaide	58%	~1pts	M
Essendon vs Brisbane Lions	Docklands	2026-05-02	Brisbane Lions	76%	~38pts	H
West Coast vs Richmond	Perth Stadium	2026-05-02	West Coast	58%	~10pts	M
Geelong vs North Melbourne	Kardinia Park	2026-05-02	Geelong	72%	~32pts	M
Carlton vs St Kilda	Docklands	2026-05-02	St Kilda	58%	~10pts	M
Sydney vs Melbourne	SCG	2026-05-03	Sydney	76%	~36pts	M
Gold Coast vs GWS Giants	Carrara	2026-05-03	GWS Giants	62%	~12pts	M

DETAILED MATCH ANALYSIS

Round 8 | MCG | 2026-04-30

Collingwood vs Hawthorn

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Hawthorn 68% win probability approx. 20pt margin

Collingwood \$4.23 (23.7% implied) | Hawthorn \$1.23 (81.2% implied) | Line: Hawthorn Hawks giving 27.5 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Hawthorn

WIN PROBABILITY: Collingwood: 32% | Hawthorn: 68%. The betting market's implied probabilities (23.7% for Collingwood and 81.2% for Hawthorn) were given a weight of 40%, the Squiggle model's probabilities (36.5% for Collingwood and 63.5% for Hawthorn) were given a weight of 30%, and the teams' recent form data were given a weight of 30%, driving the probability estimate.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~20 points. This prediction is anchored to the line market, which implies a 27.5-point margin in favor of Hawthorn, and the scoring margin averages, with Hawthorn's average margin over the last 5 games being +22.0 points.

KEY FACTORS:

- Hawthorn's recent form, with 5 consecutive wins, including a +49-point win over Gold Coast in their last game, suggests a strong team momentum.
- Collingwood's average score over the last 5 games is 83.2 points for and 72.2 points against, indicating a relatively lower scoring potential compared to Hawthorn's 99.2 points for and 77.2 points against over the same period.
- The head-to-head record between the two teams shows Hawthorn with a slight advantage, having won 3 out of the last 6 meetings, including a 110-46 win at the MCG in 2025.

4. Hawthorn's home ground advantage is significant, with a 100% win rate at home this season, although this match is being played at the MCG, a neutral ground for both teams.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS: Collingwood's last-5 average is 83.2 points for and 72.2 points against, with their last-3 average being 88.0 points for and 62.7 points against. Their attack is stable, and their defense is tightening. Hawthorn's last-5 average is 99.2 points for and 77.2 points against, with their last-3 average being 101.7 points for and 71.0 points against. Their attack and defense are both stable. Hawthorn's scoring profile gives them an advantage due to their higher average scores.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE: Collingwood has a 33% win rate at home and a 75% win rate away, indicating they perform better as visitors. Hawthorn has a 100% win rate at home and a 50% win rate away, showing a significant home ground advantage. However, since the match is at the MCG, a ground where both teams have a significant history, the home ground advantage is estimated to be minimal, around 2-3 points, given the neutral nature of the venue.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS: The head-to-head market implies a strong chance of Hawthorn winning, with an implied probability of 81.2%. The line market implies a 27.5-point margin in favor of Hawthorn. The Squiggle model predicts a Hawthorn win with an expected margin of 20.7 points. These sources generally agree, with the Squiggle model and the betting market implying a Hawthorn win, although the line market suggests a slightly larger margin than the Squiggle model.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT: Both teams have 5 days of rest, which is considered a short turnaround and may pose a fatigue risk. However, neither team has to travel, as the match is being played in Melbourne, minimizing travel fatigue.

WEATHER IMPACT: The forecast is for a max of 24°C with no rain and 18 km/h wind. These conditions are neutral and unlikely to significantly affect the result, as they do not favor one team's scoring style over the other.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT: There is limited team news available, with only general statements about selection calls and no specific ins or outs confirmed for either team.

CONFIDENCE: Medium. The data sources generally agree on a Hawthorn win, but the margin predictions vary, and the recent form of both teams, along with the neutral venue, introduces some uncertainty.

UPSET RISK: Medium. Specific data points supporting an upset include Collingwood's ability to win 3 out of the last 6 head-to-head meetings and their recent form, which includes a +77-point win over Essendon. However, these are outweighed by Hawthorn's current form and the overall trends.

DATA CONFLICTS: None identified. The data sources provided generally support a Hawthorn win, with the main conflict being in the predicted margin, where the line market suggests a larger margin than the Squiggle model.

Round 8 | Docklands | 2026-05-01

Western Bulldogs vs Fremantle

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Fremantle 58% win probability approx. 15pt margin

Western Bulldogs \$3.29 (30.4% implied) | Fremantle \$1.34 (74.7% implied) | Line: Fremantle Dockers giving 20.2 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Fremantle

WIN PROBABILITY: Western Bulldogs: 42% | Fremantle: 58%

The betting market, Squiggle model, and form data drove these probabilities, with a 40% weight given to the market's implied probabilities, 30% to the Squiggle model, and 30% to the teams' recent form, as Fremantle's strong recent performance and the market's significant implied probability for them were major factors.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~15 points

This prediction is anchored to the line market, which implies a 20.2-point margin, and adjusted based on the teams' scoring margin averages, with Fremantle's average margin of +27.6 points and Western Bulldogs' average margin of -28.2 points.

KEY FACTORS:

1. Fremantle's strong recent form, with 5 consecutive wins, including a +56-point win over West Coast, indicates a high level of performance.
2. Western Bulldogs' declining attack trend, with an average score of 60.0 points for in their last 3 games, suggests they may struggle to score against Fremantle.
3. Fremantle's stable defence trend, with an average of 57.6 points against in their last 5 games, indicates they can limit Western Bulldogs' scoring.
4. The significant difference in ladder standings, with Fremantle in 2nd position and Western Bulldogs in 10th, suggests a gap in team performance.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Western Bulldogs: last-5 average 74.6 points for, 102.8 points against; last-3 average 60.0 points for, 120.3 points against. Their attack is trending down, and their defence is leaking more.

Fremantle: last-5 average 85.2 points for, 57.6 points against; last-3 average 81.7 points for, 56.3 points against. Their attack and defence are both stable.

Fremantle's scoring profile gives them an advantage due to their stable defence and higher average score.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Western Bulldogs: 2/3 (67%) at home, 2/4 (50%) away; Fremantle: 3/3 (100%) at home, 3/4 (75%) away.

At Docklands, Western Bulldogs have a 53% win rate, while Fremantle has a 36% win rate.

The home ground advantage is estimated to be around 5-10 points, which slightly favours Western Bulldogs.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

The h2h market implies a 74.7% chance of Fremantle winning, while the line market implies a 20.2-point margin.

The Squiggle model predicts a 2.9-point win for Western Bulldogs, which disagrees with the market.

The market's implied probability and Fremantle's recent form were weighted more heavily due to their strong performance.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Western Bulldogs have 8 days rest, while Fremantle has 6 days rest and travels from Perth to Melbourne.

Fatigue may be a minor factor for Fremantle due to their short turnaround and long-haul travel.

WEATHER IMPACT:

The weather forecast is neutral, as the game is played at Marvel Stadium with a roof, which will not affect play.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

Western Bulldogs have injury concerns, including Tom Liberatore's concussion protocols, which may impact their team selection.

Fremantle has no recent team news, which suggests a stable lineup.

CONFIDENCE: Medium

The data sources partially agree, with the market and Fremantle's recent form supporting a Fremantle win, while the Squiggle model

predicts a Western Bulldogs win.

UPSET RISK: Medium

Specific data points that support an upset include Western Bulldogs' 53% win rate at Docklands and their recent win over Essendon, which suggests they can compete against strong teams.

DATA CONFLICTS:

The Squiggle model's prediction of a Western Bulldogs win conflicts with the market's implied probability and Fremantle's recent form, which both suggest a Fremantle win.

Round 8 | Adelaide Oval | 2026-05-01

Adelaide vs Port Adelaide

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Adelaide

58% win probability approx. 1pt margin

Adelaide \$1.53 (65.4% implied) | Port Adelaide \$2.54 (39.4% implied) | Line: Adelaide Crows giving 12.1 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Adelaide

WIN PROBABILITY: Adelaide: 58% | Port Adelaide: 42%

The win probability is driven by a weighted blend of the betting market (40% weight), Squiggle model (30% weight), and form data (30% weight), with the market's implied probability of 65.4% for Adelaide being adjusted downward due to the Squiggle model's predicted margin of 7.1 points and the teams' recent form.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~4 points

The predicted margin is anchored to the line market's expected margin of 12.1 points, but adjusted downward due to Adelaide's recent improvement in scoring, with an average of 97.3 points for in their last 3 games, and Port Adelaide's stable defence, with an average of 78.3 points against in their last 3 games.

KEY FACTORS:

- Adelaide's improving attack, with an average of 97.3 points for in their last 3 games, which could pose a challenge for Port Adelaide's defence.
- Port Adelaide's stable defence, with an average of 78.3 points against in their last 3 games, which could limit Adelaide's scoring opportunities.
- The head-to-head record between the two teams, with Adelaide winning 6 out of the last 8 meetings, including a 133-35 win at Adelaide Oval in 2025.
- The home ground advantage, with Adelaide having a 59% win rate at Adelaide Oval and Port Adelaide having a 62% win rate at the same venue.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Adelaide's last-5 average is 85.6 points for and 92.2 points against, while their last-3 average is 97.3 points for and 105.0 points against. Their attack is trending up, while their defence is leaking more. Port Adelaide's last-5 average is 85.6 points for and 75.0 points against, while their last-3 average is 82.7 points for and 78.3 points against. Their attack is stable, while their defence is also stable. Adelaide's improving attack gives them an advantage, but Port Adelaide's stable defence could limit their scoring opportunities.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Adelaide has a 50% win rate at home and a 59% win rate at Adelaide Oval, while Port Adelaide has a 50% win rate at home and a 62% win rate at Adelaide Oval. The point value of home advantage for this match is estimated to be around 5-10 points, given the historical data and the fact that both teams have a strong record at the venue.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

The head-to-head market implies a 65.4% chance of Adelaide winning, while the line market implies a 12.1-point margin in favour of Adelaide. The Squiggle model predicts a 7.1-point margin in favour of Adelaide. The market and model generally agree, but the model's predicted margin is lower than the market's expected margin, suggesting that the game could be closer than expected.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Adelaide has 5 days of rest, while Port Adelaide has 6 days of rest. Neither team has to travel, as the game is being played at Adelaide Oval. Fatigue is not a significant factor for this match, given the short turnaround for both teams.

WEATHER IMPACT:

The forecast is for a max temperature of 28°C, with no rain and a moderate wind. The conditions are neutral and unlikely to favour one team over the other.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

There is no team news available for either team, so it is not possible to assess the impact of any ins or outs.

CONFIDENCE: Medium

The confidence level is medium due to the fact that the data sources generally agree, but there are some conflicting signals, such as the difference between the market's expected margin and the Squiggle model's predicted margin.

UPSET RISK: Medium

The upset risk is medium due to the fact that Port Adelaide has a stable defence and a strong record at Adelaide Oval, with an average margin of +13.5 points over 155 games. Additionally, the Squiggle model's predicted margin of 7.1 points suggests that the game could be closer than expected.

DATA CONFLICTS: None identified

There are no significant conflicts between the data sources, although the difference between the market's expected margin and the Squiggle model's predicted margin is worth noting.

Round 8 | Docklands | 2026-05-02

Essendon vs Brisbane Lions

HIGH CONFIDENCE

TIP: Brisbane Lions

76% win probability approx. 38pt margin

Essendon \$7.58 (13.2% implied) | Brisbane Lions \$1.09 (91.7% implied) | Line: Brisbane Lions giving 41.6 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Brisbane Lions

WIN PROBABILITY: Essendon: 24% | Brisbane Lions: 76%

The win probability is derived from a weighted blend of the betting market (40% weight), Squiggle model (30% weight), and form data (30% weight), with the betting market and Squiggle model implying a strong Brisbane Lions win, while the form data suggests a slightly closer contest.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~38 points

The predicted margin is anchored to the line market, which implies a Brisbane Lions win by 41.6 points, and the scoring margin averages, with Brisbane Lions averaging a +32.6 point margin over the last 5 games, while Essendon averages a -17.4 point margin.

KEY FACTORS:

1. Brisbane Lions' strong recent form, with 4 wins in their last 5 games, and an average score of 110.6 points for and 78.0 points against over the last 5 games.
2. Essendon's poor recent form, with only 1 win in their last 5 games, and an average score of 83.4 points for and 100.8 points against over the last 5 games.
3. Brisbane Lions' strong head-to-head record against Essendon, with 4 wins in their last 5 meetings, and an average score of 90.2 points for and 71.8 points against.
4. Essendon's poor record at Docklands, with 0 wins in their last 5 games at the venue, and an average margin of -37.8 points.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Essendon's last-5 average is 83.4 points for and 100.8 points against, while their last-3 average is 94.3 points for and 108.0 points against, with their attack trending up and their defence trending stable. Brisbane Lions' last-5 average is 110.6 points for and 78.0 points against, while their last-3 average is 107.0 points for and 81.7 points against, with their attack and defence both trending stable. Brisbane Lions' scoring profile gives them an advantage due to their high average score and strong defence.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Essendon has a 25% win rate at home and a 0% win rate away this season, while Brisbane Lions have a 67% win rate at home and a 50% win rate away. At Docklands, Essendon has a 55% win rate historically, while Brisbane Lions have a 44% win rate. The point value of home advantage for this match is estimated to be around 5-10 points, but this is mitigated by Brisbane Lions' strong record at the venue.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

The head-to-head market implies a Brisbane Lions win, with a 91.7% implied probability. The line market implies a Brisbane Lions win by 41.6 points. The Squiggle model predicts a Brisbane Lions win by 32.8 points. The market and model agree on a Brisbane Lions win, with the model and market implying a similar margin.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Essendon has 7 days rest, while Brisbane Lions have 6 days rest and moderate travel from Brisbane to Melbourne. Fatigue is not a significant factor for this match, but the short turnaround for Brisbane Lions may have a minor impact.

WEATHER IMPACT:

The weather forecast is neutral, with the game being played at Marvel Stadium, which has a roof. The conditions will not favour one team over the other.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

Brisbane Lions have confirmed that Oscar Allen will miss the next 12-14 weeks with a foot injury, which may impact their forward line. Essendon has no significant team news.

CONFIDENCE: High

The data sources agree on a Brisbane Lions win, with the market, model, and form data all implying a strong Brisbane Lions victory.

UPSET RISK: Low

The data points that support a low upset risk include Brisbane Lions' strong recent form, their head-to-head record against Essendon, and their strong scoring profile.

DATA CONFLICTS: None identified

There are no significant conflicts between the data sources, with the market, model, and form data all implying a Brisbane Lions win.

Round 8 | Perth Stadium | 2026-05-02

West Coast vs Richmond

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: West Coast

58% win probability approx. 10pt margin

West Coast \$1.41 (70.7% implied) | Richmond \$2.89 (34.6% implied) | Line: West Coast Eagles giving 16.4 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: West Coast

WIN PROBABILITY: West Coast: 58% | Richmond: 42%

The win probability is derived from a weighted blend of the betting market (implied probabilities: West Coast 70.7%, Richmond 34.6%), the Squiggle model (West Coast 55.3%, Richmond 44.7%), and form data, with a weight of 40% on the market, 30% on the Squiggle model, and 30% on form data, which drove the probability due to West Coast's slightly better recent form and home ground advantage.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~10 points

The predicted margin is anchored to the line market (West Coast giving 16.4 points) and scoring margin averages, with West Coast's average margin over the last 5 games being -65.8 points and Richmond's being -57.4 points, but considering West Coast's home ground advantage and slightly better recent form, the margin is adjusted downwards.

KEY FACTORS:

- 1. West Coast's home ground advantage, with a historical win rate of 65% at home and an average margin of -9.6 points at Perth Stadium, which could give them an edge.
- 2. Richmond's poor recent form, with an average score of 58.6 points for and 116.0 points against over the last 5 games, which could make it difficult for them to win away from home.
- 3. West Coast's stable attack trend and Richmond's improving attack trend, which could lead to a competitive game.
- 4. The head-to-head record between the two teams, with Richmond winning 6 of the last 7 meetings, but West Coast winning 1 of the last 5 meetings at Perth Stadium, which suggests a potentially close game.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

West Coast's last-5 average is 57.2 points for and 123.0 points against, while their last-3 average is 53.0 points for and 120.7 points against, with a stable attack trend and a stable defence trend. Richmond's last-5 average is 58.6 points for and 116.0 points against, while their last-3 average is 67.3 points for and 129.0 points against, with an improving attack trend and a leaking defence trend. West Coast's scoring profile gives them a slight advantage due to their stable attack trend and home ground advantage.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

West Coast has a home win rate of 33% and an away win rate of 25% this season, while Richmond has a home win rate of 0% and an away win rate of 0% this season. At Perth Stadium, West Coast has a historical win rate of 45% and an average margin of -9.6 points, while Richmond has a historical win rate of 50% and an average margin of +5.8 points. The estimated point value of home advantage for this match is around 5-10 points, which could give West Coast an edge.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

The head-to-head market implies a West Coast win probability of 70.7%, while the line market implies a West Coast win by 16.4 points. The Squiggle model predicts a West Coast win by 8.3 points. The market and model agree on a West Coast win, but the market implies a more convincing win, while the model predicts a closer game. The Squiggle model is weighted more heavily due to its more

conservative prediction, which is supported by the head-to-head record and recent form.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

West Coast has 6 days of rest, while Richmond has 8 days of rest. Richmond has to travel from Melbourne to Perth, which could be a factor. However, given the rest days, fatigue is not a significant factor for this match.

WEATHER IMPACT:

The weather forecast is unavailable, so it is unclear whether the conditions will favour one team over the other. However, given the lack of information, it is assumed that the weather will have a neutral impact on the game.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

There is no team news available for either West Coast or Richmond, so there are no confirmed ins or outs to consider. This lack of information means that the team news will not have a significant impact on the prediction.

CONFIDENCE: Medium

The confidence level is medium due to the agreement between the market and model on a West Coast win, but the relatively close predicted margin and the uncertainty surrounding the weather and team news.

UPSET RISK: Medium

The upset risk is medium due to Richmond's improving attack trend and their historical win rate of 50% at Perth Stadium, which suggests that they could potentially cause an upset if they can capitalize on West Coast's stable defence trend and exploit their home ground advantage.

DATA CONFLICTS: None identified

There are no significant conflicts between the data sources, with the market, model, and form data all suggesting a West Coast win, although with varying degrees of conviction.

Round 8 | Kardinia Park | 2026-05-02

Geelong vs North Melbourne

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Geelong

72% win probability approx. 32pt margin

Geelong \$1.22 (81.7% implied) | North Melbourne \$4.23 (23.7% implied) | Line: Geelong Cats giving 28.5 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Geelong

WIN PROBABILITY: Geelong: 72% | North Melbourne: 28%

The win probability is derived from a weighted blend of the betting market (40%), Squiggle model (30%), and form data (30%), with the market's implied probabilities adjusted to remove the bookmaker's overround, and the Squiggle model's prediction of a 39.2-point margin in Geelong's favor also influencing the probability.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~32 points

The predicted margin is anchored to the line market of 28.5 points and the average margin of Geelong's last 5 games, which is +19.6 points, and also considers the Squiggle model's expected margin of 39.2 points, with a slight adjustment downwards due to North Melbourne's stable defense trend.

KEY FACTORS:

- 1. Geelong's significant home ground advantage, with a 100% win rate at Kardinia Park this season and a historical win rate of 68% at the venue.
- 2. North Melbourne's short turnaround of 6 days rest, which may lead to fatigue and impact their performance.
- 3. Geelong's improving attack trend, with an average score of 106.0 points in their last 3 games, which may give them an edge in scoring.
- 4. The head-to-head record between the two teams, with Geelong having won the last 6 meetings, including a 49-150 win at Docklands in 2025.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Geelong's last-5 average is 95.4 points for and 75.8 points against, while their last-3 average is 106.0 points for and 75.7 points against. Their attack is trending up, while their defense is stable. North Melbourne's last-5 average is 94.2 points for and 81.4 points against, while their last-3 average is 98.0 points for and 84.0 points against. Their attack and defense are both stable. Geelong's scoring profile gives them an advantage due to their improving attack trend and stable defense.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Geelong has a 100% win rate at home this season, while North Melbourne has a 75% win rate at home and a 33% win rate away. Geelong has a strong record at Kardinia Park, with a historical win rate of 68% and an average margin of +18.0 points. North Melbourne has a poor record at Kardinia Park, with a historical win rate of 40% and an average margin of -14.4 points. The estimated point value of home advantage for this match is around 10-15 points.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

The head-to-head market implies a Geelong win, with an implied probability of 81.7%. The line market implies a Geelong win by 28.5 points. The Squiggle model predicts a Geelong win by 39.2 points. The market and model agree on a Geelong win, but the model predicts a larger margin.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Geelong has 7 days rest, while North Melbourne has 6 days rest and travels from Melbourne to Geelong. Fatigue may be a real factor for North Melbourne due to their short turnaround.

WEATHER IMPACT:

The forecast is for a maximum temperature of 24°C, with a 56% chance of rain and wind of 24 km/h. The conditions may be slightly slippery, which may reduce kicking accuracy, but they do not favor one team over the other based on their scoring style.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

No team news is available for either team, so there is no impact from ins/outs or positional changes.

CONFIDENCE: Medium

The data sources generally agree on a Geelong win, but the margin predictions vary, and the short turnaround for North Melbourne adds some uncertainty.

UPSET RISK: Low

The data points that support a low upset risk include Geelong's strong home ground advantage, their improving attack trend, and the head-to-head record between the two teams.

DATA CONFLICTS: None identified

There are no cases where two data sources gave contradictory signals.

Round 8 | Docklands | 2026-05-02

Carlton vs St Kilda

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: St Kilda

58% win probability approx. 10pt margin

Carlton \$2.74 (36.5% implied) | St Kilda \$1.46 (68.7% implied) | Line: St Kilda Saints giving 14.5 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: St Kilda

WIN PROBABILITY: Carlton: 42% | St Kilda: 58%

The win probability is driven by a weighted blend of the betting market (45% weight), Squiggle model (30% weight), and form data (25% weight), with the market's implied probabilities and the Squiggle model's prediction both favouring St Kilda.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~10 points

The predicted margin is anchored to the line market, which implies a 14.5-point margin, and the scoring margin averages, with St Kilda's average margin over the last 5 games being +17.0 points, while Carlton's is -16.0 points.

KEY FACTORS:

- St Kilda's improving attack trend, with an average score of 108.7 points over the last 3 games, compared to Carlton's stable attack trend with an average score of 86.0 points over the same period.
- Carlton's poor recent form, with 0 wins in their last 5 games, and an average margin of -16.0 points over that period.
- St Kilda's strong record at Docklands, with a 55% win rate over their last 5 games at the venue, and an average margin of +17.0 points.
- The significant home ground advantage for Carlton, with a 33% higher win rate at home, but this may be mitigated by St Kilda's strong record at Docklands.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Carlton's last-5 average is 84.2 points for and 100.2 points against, while their last-3 average is 86.0 points for and 101.7 points against. Their attack is trending stable, while their defence is also stable. St Kilda's last-5 average is 96.8 points for and 79.8 points against, while their last-3 average is 108.7 points for and 70.7 points against. Their attack is trending up, while their defence is tightening. St Kilda's scoring profile gives them an advantage due to their improving attack trend and strong defensive record.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Carlton has a home win rate of 33% and an away win rate of 0% this season, while St Kilda has a home win rate of 33% and an away win rate of 50%. At Docklands, Carlton has a record of 1W-4L over their last 5 games, while St Kilda has a record of 4W-1L. The estimated point value of home advantage for this match is around 5-10 points, but this may be mitigated by St Kilda's strong record at the venue.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

The head-to-head market implies a 68.7% chance of St Kilda winning, while the line market implies a 14.5-point margin in favour of St Kilda. The Squiggle model predicts a 7.7-point margin in favour of St Kilda. The market and model generally agree, with the Squiggle model's prediction being slightly more conservative.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Carlton has 7 days rest, while St Kilda has 6 days rest, which may be a fatigue factor due to the short turnaround. However, neither team has significant travel, as both teams are based in Melbourne.

WEATHER IMPACT:

The weather forecast is neutral, as the game is being played at Marvel Stadium, which has a roof, and therefore weather conditions will not affect play.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

There is limited team news available, with no confirmed ins or outs for either team. The only news is that Carlton midfielder George Hewett is reportedly seeking a trade, but this is unlikely to have a significant impact on the game.

CONFIDENCE: Medium

The confidence level is medium, as while the data sources generally agree, there is some uncertainty due to the short turnaround for St Kilda and the significant home ground advantage for Carlton.

UPSET RISK: Medium

The upset risk is medium, with specific data points supporting an upset being Carlton's significant home ground advantage, their stable attack trend, and St Kilda's short turnaround.

DATA CONFLICTS: None identified.

Round 8 | SCG | 2026-05-03

Sydney vs Melbourne

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Sydney

76% win probability approx. 36pt margin

Sydney \$1.18 (85.0% implied) | Melbourne \$4.93 (20.3% implied) | Line: Sydney Swans giving 31.6 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Sydney

WIN PROBABILITY: Sydney: 76% | Melbourne: 24%

Derivation: Weighted 40% Squiggle model (Sydney 74.2%), 35% betting market (Sydney 85.0% implied, adjusted for 5pp overround = 80%), and 25% form/venue data (Sydney 80%+ at home). The three inputs converge on a strong Sydney advantage, justifying a midpoint estimate of 76%.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~36 points

Justification: Squiggle model predicts 40.0pt margin; betting line is 31.6pts. Sydney's last-5 average margin is +50.0pts, though this includes a +128pt outlier (West Coast). Excluding outliers, last-5 realistic margin is ~+35-40pts. Melbourne's last-5 average margin is only +10.8pts, indicating they are significantly outscored in close contests. SCG venue data: Sydney average margin at home is +23.8pts (last 5 games), Melbourne average margin away at SCG is 0.5pts (last 2 games). Convergence on 36pts represents a conservative midpoint between model and market.

KEY FACTORS:

1. Scoring differential at SCG (Sydney's home): Sydney averages 115.6pts for and 65.6pts against (50.0pt differential) over last 5

games; Melbourne averages 101.4pts for and 90.6pts against (10.8pt differential). At SCG specifically, Sydney has a 60% historical win rate (273W-185L, avg margin +11.8pts) vs Melbourne's 40% (12W-18L, avg margin 11.3pts). This represents a 23.1pt structural advantage to Sydney at this venue.

2. Home ground win rate gap: Sydney's home win rate this season is 100% (4/4 games, 33pp higher than away rate of 67%). Melbourne's away win rate is only 50% (2/4 games, 50pp lower than home rate of 100%). The 33pp gap for Sydney and 50pp gap for Melbourne indicate both teams are significantly weaker away, but Melbourne's away weakness is more pronounced.

3. Defensive resilience: Sydney's defence has conceded an average of 65.6pts (last 5) and 64.7pts (last 3), with stable trend. Melbourne's defence has conceded 90.6pts (last 5) and 95.7pts (last 3), with stable trend. Sydney's defence is 25.0pts stronger in absolute terms. Melbourne's last-3 defensive average of 95.7pts indicates deteriorating defensive performance in recent games.

4. Head-to-head neutrality at SCG: H2H data shows Sydney 1W-1L at SCG (last 2 meetings), with Melbourne winning by 21pts in 2025 and Sydney winning by 22pts in 2024. While historical SCG data favours Sydney (60% win rate over 458 games), recent SCG meetings are split, providing no clear momentum signal.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Sydney (last 5): 115.6pts for | 65.6pts against | Trend: Attack stable, Defence stable

Sydney (last 3): 111.0pts for | 64.7pts against | Trend: Attack stable, Defence stable

Melbourne (last 5): 101.4pts for | 90.6pts against | Trend: Attack stable, Defence stable

Melbourne (last 3): 99.3pts for | 95.7pts against | Trend: Attack stable, Defence stable

Advantage: Sydney. Sydney's attack averages 14.2pts higher than Melbourne's (115.6 vs 101.4 over last 5). More critically, Sydney's defence is 25.0pts stronger (65.6 conceded vs 90.6). Melbourne's defensive trend shows deterioration in last-3 (95.7 conceded) vs last-5 (90.6 conceded), a +5.1pt increase in points conceded. Both teams show stable trends, so the advantage is structural (Sydney is simply more efficient on both ends) rather than momentum-based.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Sydney this season:

- Home: 4/4 (100%)
- Away: 2/3 (67%)
- +33 percentage point advantage at home

Melbourne this season:

- Home: 3/3 (100%)
- Away: 2/4 (50%)
- +50 percentage point advantage at home

Venue-specific (SCG):

- Sydney last 5 games at SCG: 4W-1L, avg margin +23.8pts
- Melbourne last 2 games at SCG: 1W-1L, avg margin 0.5pts
- Sydney historical at SCG: 273W-185L (60% win rate), avg 102.0 vs 90.2 (margin +11.8pts) over 458 games
- Melbourne historical at SCG: 12W-18L (40% win rate), avg 91.8 vs 103.1 (margin 11.3pts) over 30 games

Home advantage point estimate: Standard AFL home ground advantage is valued at 5-10pts. For this match, the data suggests Sydney's advantage is meaningfully above standard: Sydney's 33pp home/away gap and +23.8pt average margin at SCG (last 5) suggest approximately 15-18 points of venue advantage. Melbourne's 50pp home/away gap indicates they would typically be favoured at the MCG, but at SCG, they have a 11.3pt historical margin. This compounds Sydney's advantage.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

Betting markets (win): Sydney \$1.18 (85.0% implied) vs Melbourne \$4.93 (20.3% implied)

- These imply Sydney by a significant margin, but include bookmaker overround (~5pp). Adjusted: Sydney ~80%, Melbourne ~20%.

Line market: Sydney giving 31.6pts (expected margin)

- The line is tighter than Squiggle's 40pt prediction, suggesting either market conservatism or that the line is set to balance action rather than reflect true expectation.

Squiggle model: Sydney 74.2% | Melbourne 25.8%, expected margin 40.0pts

- This is the only pure statistical model in the dataset.

Agreement/disagreement: The win-percentage markets and Squiggle model agree strongly (Sydney 80-85% vs 74.2% Squiggle). The line market (31.6pts) is tighter than Squiggle (40.0pts), suggesting the market may be pricing in some mean reversion or Melbourne resistance. However, form data (Sydney +50pt average margin, Melbourne +10.8pt) and venue data (Sydney +23.8pts at SCG) support Squiggle's 40pt estimate more than the 31.6pt line.

Weighting: I weighted Squiggle (40%) and form/venue data (40%) more heavily than the line market (20%) because the line market may be set to balance betting action rather than reflect true expectation. The win probability markets are useful as a cross-check but the line discrepancy warrants deeper scrutiny.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Sydney: 10 days rest | Playing at home (SCG, Sydney)

Melbourne: 9 days rest | Short travel (Melbourne to Sydney, ~1h25m flight)

Assessment: Both teams have adequate rest (9-10 days). The 1-day difference is negligible. Melbourne's travel is brief (90 minutes) and interstate travel to Sydney is routine for AFL teams. Travel fatigue is not a meaningful factor in this match. Both teams should be at full readiness.

WEATHER IMPACT:

Forecast for SCG on 2026-05-03: Max 24°C, 0.0mm rain (7% chance), 20 km/h wind

Assessment: Conditions are neutral and benign. No rain expected; temperature is mild; wind at 20 km/h is moderate and standard for Sydney autumn. Neither team's scoring style (Sydney balanced attack/defence; Melbourne modest attack) is weather-dependent. Weather is not a meaningful factor for this match.

**TEAM NEWS

Round 8 | Carrara | 2026-05-03

Gold Coast vs GWS Giants

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: GWS Giants

62% win probability approx. 12pt margin

Gold Coast \$1.38 (72.6% implied) | GWS Giants \$3.08 (32.5% implied) | Line: Gold Coast Suns giving 18.4 pts

PREDICTION: Gold Coast vs GWS Giants | Round 8 | 2026-05-03

PREDICTED WINNER: GWS Giants

WIN PROBABILITY: Gold Coast: 38% | GWS Giants: 62%

(Derived from: H2H dominance weighted 40%, home ground disadvantage weighted 25%, recent form weighted 20%, betting market (debiased) weighted 15%. The market's 72.6% for Gold Coast incorporates home advantage but significantly underweights GWS Giants' 6-game winning streak vs Gold Coast and their superior away record this season [0-3 against 1-4]. Removing bookmaker overround from the 1.38/\$3.08 line gives approximately 65/35 split; H2H historical data pulls this toward Giants.)

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~GWS Giants by 12 points

(Anchor: betting line of Gold Coast -18.4 is overcorrected for home advantage. GWS Giants' 3-year away record at Carrara is 62% (8W-5L, avg margin -1.1 pts), vs Gold Coast's home record this season of 100% (3W-0L) but against weaker opponents. Last 5 games at Carrara: Gold Coast +36.8 avg margin, but GWS Giants +35.0 in their single Carrara visit this season. Gold Coast's last-3 scoring average (83.3 pts for) is declining sharply; GWS Giants' last-3 (100.7 pts for) is improving. Margin accounts for home ground worth ~5-10 pts, offset by GWS Giants' superior form trajectory and H2H record.)

KEY FACTORS:

- H2H Historical Dominance (GWS Giants): GWS Giants have won the last 6 consecutive meetings vs Gold Coast (0W-6L record for Gold Coast). In these 6 games, GWS Giants averaged 101.5 pts while Gold Coast averaged 72.3 pts--a 29.2 pt differential. This is not random variance; it represents systematic competitive imbalance across multiple seasons and venues.
- Attacking Trend Divergence: Gold Coast's attack has declined to 83.3 pts avg over last 3 games (down from 93.4 over last 5), while GWS Giants' attack has improved to 100.7 pts over last 3 (up from 86.0 over last 5). This 17.4 pt swing in scoring differential favors GWS Giants entering this match.
- Defensive Vulnerability (Gold Coast): Gold Coast's defence is leaking more, conceding 107.3 pts avg over last 3 games. GWS Giants' defence remains stable at 93.3 pts conceded over last 3. Against an improving GWS attack (100.7 pts) and vulnerable Gold Coast defence (107.3 pts conceded), GWS Giants' offensive output aligns with Gold Coast's defensive weaknesses.
- Away Performance Penalty (GWS Giants) Partially Offset: While GWS Giants are 0-3 away this season (concerning), their 3-year away record is 63W-157 (40% win rate). At the specific venue (Carrara), GWS Giants are 8W-5L (62% win rate, -1.1 avg margin). This suggests Carrara is a relatively strong away fixture for GWS Giants compared to their broader away record.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Gold Coast (Last 5): 93.4 pts for, 98.2 pts against | Last 3: 83.3 pts for, 107.3 pts against

- Attack trend: declining v (10.1 pt drop in 3-game window)
- Defence trend: deteriorating ^ (9.1 pt increase in points conceded)
- This is a compounding problem: scoring fewer while conceding more.

GWS Giants (Last 5): 86.0 pts for, 89.0 pts against | Last 3: 100.7 pts for, 93.3 pts against

- Attack trend: improving ^ (14.7 pt increase in 3-game window)
- Defence trend: stable (only -4.3 pt variance)
- GWS Giants are moving in the opposite direction: scoring more while maintaining defensive discipline.

Advantage: GWS Giants. The divergence is substantial and recent. Gold Coast's 83.3 pts for over last 3 is their lowest output in the data window; GWS Giants' 100.7 pts for is their highest. In matchups where one team is scoring 100+ and the other 83, the scoring advantage is decisive.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Gold Coast (Home this match):

- Season home/away: 3W-0L at home (100%) | 1W-4L away (25%) -- 75 pp home advantage this season

- At Carrara specifically (last 5): 4W-1L (80%) | avg margin +36.8 pts
- Historical at Carrara (3-year): 62W-83L (43% win rate, avg margin -6.2 pts over 145 games)
- Contradiction noted: Recent Carrara form (4-1, +36.8) conflicts with 3-year Carrara record (43%, -6.2). This suggests recent opponent quality was weak.

GWS Giants (Away this match):

- Season away: 0W-3L (0% away record) -- 75 pp home advantage vs their away record
- At Carrara specifically (last 1): 1W-0L | avg margin +35.0 pts
- Historical at Carrara (3-year): 8W-5L (62% win rate, avg margin -1.1 pts over 13 games)
- Pattern: GWS Giants perform considerably better at Carrara (-1.1 margin) than at neutral/away venues generally (-3.0 margin last 5).

Home Ground Estimate: AFL standard is 5-10 pts for home advantage. Gold Coast's 100% home record this season suggests home advantage is functioning (worth ~7-8 pts). However, GWS Giants' 62% win rate at this specific venue historically (vs 40% away overall) means the venue-specific factor partially negates Gold Coast's general home advantage. Adjusted estimate: Gold Coast home advantage worth ~4-5 pts in this fixture, less than the standard 5-10 pt range due to GWS Giants' relative Carrara competency.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

H2H/Win Market: Betting market implies Gold Coast 72.6% | GWS Giants 32.5% (includes bookmaker overround of ~5-8%).

- Debiased, this suggests approximately 68-70% Gold Coast | 30-32% GWS Giants.
- This contradicts the H2H record (GWS Giants 6-0 in last 6) and recent form divergence (GWS improving, Gold Coast declining).
- Market appears to be overweighting Gold Coast's home ground advantage and underweighting structural H2H imbalance.

Line Market: Gold Coast giving 18.4 pts.

- This is substantially higher than the 3-year average margin at Carrara for Gold Coast (-6.2 pts) or GWS Giants (-1.1 pts).
- 18.4 pts is approximately 3x the GWS Giants' 3-year Carrara margin average.
- This suggests the market is pricing in a confidence in Gold Coast's home form that recent season data does not support across broader context.

Squiggle Model: Not available for this match.

Market Consensus: All three data sources (implied win%, line, totals at 187 pts) assume Gold Coast comfortable. The market is not incorporating the severity of the H2H trend (0-6 over 6 matches) or the attacking/defensive trend divergence. I weighted H2H historical pattern (40%) and form divergence (20%) more heavily than the market's 72.6% Gold Coast, reducing my Gold Coast probability to 38%.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Gold Coast: